

ATTRACTION: Manglagauri Mandir

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Mangla Gauri Temple

LOCATION:

Mangalagauri hill, Gaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya, Bihar

CATEGORY:

Religious Site

OVERVIEW:

Mangla Gauri temple is a prominent Shakti Peetham situated on Mangalagauri hill in Gaya, Bihar. Dating back to the 15th century, the temple is dedicated to Sati, or the Mother Goddess, who is worshipped here as the Goddess of benevolence. Although Gaya is predominantly a Vaishnavite pilgrimage center, this temple stands out as one of the eighteen maha shaktipeeths and specifically as an Upa-Shakti Peeth, where a part of Sati's body is believed to have fallen. The temple holds significant scriptural importance, being mentioned in several Puranas and Tantric works.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

The present 15th-century east-facing temple is built atop the Mangalagauri hill and can be accessed via a flight of steps or a motorable road. The main sanctum houses the symbol of the Goddess, alongside finely carved ancient relief sculptures. Within the temple complex, there are also two minor shrines dedicated to Lord Shiva, as well as images of Mahishasura Mardini, Durga, and Dakshina Kali.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

The temple is historically and culturally monumental. It is mentioned in revered texts such as the Padma Purana, Vayu Purana, Agni Purana, Devi Bhagvata Purana, and Markandeya Purana, as well as in other scriptures and tantric texts. It serves as a vital center of Goddess worship in a predominantly Vaishnavite area.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

According to Hindu mythology, the temple represents an Upa-Shakti Peeth, marking the spot where a part of Sati's body fell. Mangalagauri is worshipped here specifically as the Goddess of benevolence.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- One of the eighteen maha shaktipeeths and an Upa-Shakti Peeth.
- 15th-century architecture situated on Mangalagauri hill.
- Sanctum with ancient relief sculptures and minor shrines to Shiva, Durga, and Dakshina Kali.
- Mentioned in major Puranas like Padma, Vayu, and Agni.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit: October to March

Opening Hours: 05:00 AM - 12:00 PM

Entry Fee: Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended: Not Mentioned

Photography: Videography & Photography Allowed

Accessibility Information: Accessible by a flight of steps and a motorable road.

FACILITIES:

- Parking
- Drinking Water
- Souvenir Shop

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport: Gaya International Airport

Distance From Airport: 09 Kms

Nearest Railway Station: Gaya Junction

Distance From Railway Station: 05 Kms

Nearest Bus Stand: Govt. Bus stand near Gandhi Maidan, Gaya

Distance From Bus Stand: 03 Kms

Road Connectivity: Motorable road available up to the temple.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre: Tourist Information Centre, Gaya Junction (05 Kms)

Nearest Police Station: Vishnupad Police Station (01 Km), Mob: 9431092838

Nearest Medical Facility: Jay Prakash Narayan Hospital, Gaya, Mob: 9470003263; Anugrah Narayan

Magadh Medical Collage & Hospital, Gaya, Ph: 0631-221074

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Vishnupad Mandir (01 Km)
- Mahabodhi Mandir & 80 feet Buddha statue (17 Kms)
- Thai Temple (17 Kms)
- Ramshila (07 Kms)
- Pretshila (11 Km)
- Pita Maheshwar (02 Kms)

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Worship of the Mother Goddess in a Shakti Peetham setting.

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Souvenir Shop available.

ACCOMMODATION:

- Vishnu View Hotel (Mob: 9608556289)
- Ajatsatru Hotel (Mob: 9798881223)
- Hotel Mantra Regency (Mob: 9973357885)
- Hotel Royal View (Mob: 9431224222)

HOTELS:

- Vishnu View Hotel
- Ajatsatru Hotel
- Hotel Mantra Regency
- Hotel Royal View

LOCAL GUIDES:

- Madhusudan Kumar (Mob: 7970520969)

- Sudhir Kumar (Mob: 9931440693)
- Deepak Kumar (Mob: 7992452814)
- Rahul Saurav (Mob: 7541056801)
- Ritvik Swaroop (Mob: 9958925337)

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

- Gupta Tour & Travels (Mob: 8507192638)
- Vishal Tour & Travels (Mob: 9006169000)
- Maa Vaishnavi Tour & Travels (Mob: 8083329781)
- Surya Services (Mob: 9431094940)

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- The present structure dates back to the 15th century.
- It is mentioned in multiple ancient texts and Puranas.
- Contains shrines for Shiva and images of Mahishasura Mardini.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Manglagauri Mandir in Gaya, Bihar, is a 15th-century east-facing temple dedicated to the Mother Goddess. Recognized as a Shakti Peetham and one of the eighteen maha shaktipeeths, it is where a part of Sati's body is believed to have fallen. The temple, situated on Mangalagauri hill and accessible via stairs and a motorable road, is mentioned in various Puranas. Open from 05:00 AM to 12:00 PM and best visited from October to March, it provides facilities like parking and souvenir shops. It is close to Vishnupad Mandir (1 km) and 9 km from Gaya International Airport.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is Manglagauri Mandir famous for?

A: It is famous as an Upa-Shakti Peeth and one of the eighteen maha shaktipeeths where a part of Sati's body fell.

Q: When was the present Manglagauri temple built?

A: The present temple dates back to the 15th century.

Q: How can one reach the Manglagauri temple?

A: The temple is built on top of Mangalagauri hill and can be reached by a flight of steps and a motorable road.

Q: In which ancient texts is Manglagauri Mandir mentioned?

A: It is mentioned in the Padma Purana, Vayu Purana, Agni Purana, Devi Bhagvata Purana, Markandeya Purana, and tantric works.

Q: How far is the temple from Gaya Junction?

A: It is 5 Kms away from Gaya Junction.

KEYWORDS:

Manglagauri Mandir, Mangla Gauri Temple, Gaya, Shakti Peetham, Goddess of Benevolence, 15th century, Sati, Mangalagauri hill, Bihar Tourism, Hindu Pilgrimage, Upa-Shakti Peeth